

Klaviyo Setup — Step-by-Step Guide

For: Courtney **From:** Hamid **Estimated time:** Two evenings, ~2 hours each **You'll need:** Logged in to Klaviyo as admin

What we're doing & why

Klaviyo is the part of your stack that sends the **9 lifecycle emails** to families. The app already does its half of the work — it watches what's happening in the business (a family subscribes, two kids get matched, a parent cancels, etc.) and rings a "doorbell" each time something important happens.

Your job in these two evenings is to set up Klaviyo to **listen for those doorbells and send the right email when one rings**.

Think of the app as a **smoke alarm** and Klaviyo as the **fire-station phone tree** — the app knows when something's happening, Klaviyo knows what message to send to whom and when.

Quick concepts (one minute)

Three things you'll see in Klaviyo over and over:

- **Metric** — Klaviyo's word for one of the "doorbells" the app rings. Each metric has a name like `Match Promoted To Active` (these are the exact names the app uses — case matters).
- **Flow** — a little recipe: *when X happens, wait Y days, send Z email*. You build one flow per email below.
- **Profile properties** — extra info that comes with each doorbell ring (the parent's first name, their child's name, etc.). You drop these into your email using `{{ event.child_first_name }}` style placeholders.

If a metric name doesn't appear in Klaviyo's search yet, **don't panic** — it only appears after the app has fired that event for the first time. You can still build the flow, just type the metric name exactly and Klaviyo will save it.

Evening 1 — The everyday flows (K1 to K5)

These are the ones every active family experiences. Get these right first.

□ K1 — Welcome (Day 0)

What it does: First email a brand-new family gets, with the link to add their child's profile. **Trigger:** When someone subscribes via Shopify. **Where this fires from:** The app rings the doorbell `family_subscribed` the moment Shopify tells us a new subscription started.

In Klaviyo:

1. Flows → Create Flow → "Create from Scratch"
2. Name: `K1 - Welcome (Day 0)`
3. Trigger: **Metric** → **search for** `family_subscribed`
4. No wait — send immediately
5. Add Email block → paste your welcome copy
6. Personalization to use in the email:
 - `{{ person.first_name }}` — parent's first name
 - `{{ event.onboarding_url }}` — **important** — the unique link to add their child's info. This is what makes the welcome email useful, so don't forget to put it on the big button.
 - `{{ event.tier }}` — Core / Minis / Homeschool Core etc.
 - `{{ event.billing_type }}` — Monthly / Annual
7. Set status to **Live**

Note: Klaviyo's built-in Shopify integration may also fire a "Started Subscription" event from Shopify directly. You can use that instead of `family_subscribed` if you prefer, but you'll lose the personalized `onboarding_url` — the app generates that.

□ K2 — First-letter nudge (Day 14)

What it does: Two weeks after pen pals are matched (and both addresses confirmed), gently nudge the family in case they haven't written their first letter yet. **Trigger:** App rings `match_promoted_to_active` once both parents confirm addresses.

In Klaviyo:

1. Flows → Create Flow → "Create from Scratch"
2. Name: `K2 - First-letter nudge (Day 14)`
3. Trigger: **Metric** → `match_promoted_to_active`
4. Add a **Time Delay** block: **14 days**
5. Add Email block → paste your nudge copy
6. Personalization:
 - `{{ person.first_name }}` — parent's first name
 - `{{ event.child_first_name }}` — their child's name

- `{{ event.pal_first_name }}` — the pen pal's name

7. Status: **Live**

❑ K3 — Monthly pack: Core

What it does: Heads-up that this month's pack is on its way. **Trigger:** Scheduled — 1st of every month.

In Klaviyo:

1. Lists & Segments → Create Segment
 - Name: `Core members - active`
 - Condition: `membership_tier` equals `Core` AND `subscription_status` equals `Active`
 2. Campaigns → Create Campaign → Email
 3. Name: `K3 - Monthly pack - Core`
 4. Recipients: the `Core members - active` segment
 5. Schedule: monthly recurring on the 1st
 6. Paste copy + schedule. Status: **Live**
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❑ K4 — Monthly pack: Minis

Same as K3 but for the segment:

- Name: `Minis members - active`
 - Condition: `membership_tier` equals `Minis` OR `Homeschool Minis` AND `subscription_status` equals `Active`
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❑ K5 — Monthly pack: Homeschool

Same as K3 but for the segment:

- Name: `Homeschool members - active`
- Condition: `membership_tier` equals `Homeschool Core` OR `Homeschool Minis` AND `subscription_status` equals `Active`

Tip: Save K3 first, then "duplicate" it for K4 and K5 — Klaviyo lets you copy a campaign and just swap the segment. Saves 20 minutes.

End of Evening 1. Save your progress. The 5 flows above are the heart of the system — if you stop here, the app's email game is already in much better shape than today.

Evening 2 — The rescue + special flows (K6 to K9) + the two webhooks

These handle the harder cases (a family going quiet, a cancellation, donations).

□ K6 — Ghosting win-back sequence (3–4 emails)

What it does: When a family stops opening their monthly pack emails for a couple of months, send them a short series of “are you still with us?” emails. If those don’t work, send a **handwritten Poppy card** by hand.

The chain:

1. **Segment:** “Hasn’t opened K3/K4/K5 in 45 days”
 - Lists & Segments → Create Segment
 - Condition: `Has not opened Email` for any of `K3/K4/K5` in the last 45 days, AND `subscription_status` equals `Active`
2. **Flow:** triggered by segment membership
 - Name: `K6 – Ghosting win-back`
 - Trigger: **When someone enters the segment above**
 - **Step 1 — Webhook action:** POST to `https://[your-app-url]/api/webhooks/klaviyo/at-risk`
 - This tells the app the family is going quiet so it flags them as “At Risk” inside the admin tool.
 - **Step 2 — Email 1:** “We miss you” — wait 0 days
 - **Step 3 — Wait 4 days**
 - **Step 4 — Email 2:** “Here’s what’s coming this month”
 - **Step 5 — Wait 4 days**
 - **Step 6 — Email 3:** “One last note”
 - **Step 7 — Webhook action:** POST to `https://[your-app-url]/api/webhooks/klaviyo/winback-completed`
 - This tells the app “*the email series finished and they still haven’t re-engaged*”. The app then creates a Poppy-card task in your Action Items so you know to write them a handwritten card.

For the webhook URLs above — Hamid will send you the actual URL + a small “secret” string that needs to go in a header called `x-klaviyo-secret`. This stops random people on the internet from poking at your app.

□ K7 — Day-30 win-back (post-cancel)

What it does: 30 days after a family cancels, send one last “we’d love to have you back” email with maybe a small offer. **Trigger:** App rings `family_offboarded` when a cancellation has been fully

processed (after the 48-hour grace period).

In Klaviyo:

1. Flows → Create Flow → “Create from Scratch”
 2. Name: `K7 – Day-30 win-back`
 3. Trigger: **Metric** → `family_offboarded`
 4. Add a **Time Delay** block: **30 days**
 5. Add Email block → paste your copy
 6. Personalization:
 - `{{ person.first_name }}` — parent’s first name
 - `{{ event.reason }}` — the reason they cancelled (you can use this to branch — for example, skip if `reason` is “moved to digital only”)
 7. Status: **Live**
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❑ K8 — Annual upgrade offer

What it does: At day 90 of monthly billing, offer to switch them to annual (often with a small bonus).

Trigger: Segment based on subscription age. No app involvement.

In Klaviyo:

1. Lists & Segments → Create Segment
 - Name: `Monthly members at day 90`
 - Conditions:
 - `billing_type` equals `Monthly`
 - `subscription_status` equals `Active`
 - `subscription_start_date` was *exactly* 90 days ago (use Klaviyo’s “Date is X days ago” condition)
 2. Campaigns → Create Campaign → Email
 3. Name: `K8 – Annual upgrade offer`
 4. Send daily to anyone newly matching the segment (Klaviyo can do this — “Smart Sending” / “Send to new members of segment”).
 5. Status: **Live**
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❑ K9 — Give a Key donor thank-you

What it does: Thanks someone for donating to the Give-a-Key fund. **Trigger:** A donation gets recorded. **(See note below — we’re waiting on DonateMate’s answer before deciding.)**

Two possible setups — Hamid will confirm which one before you build this:

- **Option A (if DonateMate sends donations to Klaviyo directly):** Klaviyo will receive a metric from DonateMate (probably called something like `Donation Received`). Build the flow with that metric as the trigger.
- **Option B (if the app needs to send the doorbell):** Trigger: Metric → `gak_donation_recorded`
Personalization available:
 - `{{ person.first_name }}` — donor's first name
 - `{{ event.amount }}` — donation amount
 - `{{ event.donation_id }}` — reference number

Don't build K9 yet — wait for Hamid's note on the DonateMate question. Should arrive in the next few days.

❑ Webhook secrets — one-time setup

The two webhooks K6 fires into the app (`/at-risk` and `/winback-completed`) need a shared secret so the app knows the request really came from your Klaviyo, not from someone pretending.

Hamid will send you:

1. The actual webhook URLs (full https addresses)
2. The exact secret string to paste into each Klaviyo webhook action under the header `x-klaviyo-secret`

Just paste them into the two Webhook actions in the K6 flow — that's it.

❑ Test mode — before going Live

Klaviyo lets you test any flow by clicking **"Preview"** → **"Send to me"** with a fake event. For each flow you built:

1. Click into the flow
2. Hit **"Preview"** on the email block
3. Send a test to your own email
4. Open it on your phone — does the personalization look right? (No empty `{{ }}` placeholders showing through?)
5. If yes → flip flow to **Live**

Most common gotcha: an empty `{{ event.child_first_name }}` showing through means either (a) the event doesn't carry that property (check above — I've listed every variable available per flow), or (b)

you typed the variable name slightly differently. Klaviyo's variable picker has them all — use the dropdown rather than typing freehand.

☐ When you're done — quick checklist

- ☐ K1 Welcome — Live
- ☐ K2 First-letter nudge — Live
- ☐ K3 Monthly pack Core — Scheduled
- ☐ K4 Monthly pack Minis — Scheduled
- ☐ K5 Monthly pack Homeschool — Scheduled
- ☐ K6 Ghosting win-back — Live (including both webhook actions)
- ☐ K7 Day-30 win-back — Live
- ☐ K8 Annual upgrade — Live
- ☐ K9 Donor thank-you — Live (*after Hamid confirms DonateMate path*)

Once they're all ticked, message Hamid — he'll run an end-to-end test with a synthetic family to confirm every email lands in the right inbox at the right time.

Stuck?

Three best ways to unstick yourself:

1. **Klaviyo's metric search not showing the name?** That's fine — it only appears after the first real event. Type it exactly and save.
2. **Variable showing as empty `{{ }}` ?** Use Klaviyo's variable dropdown instead of typing — it lists everything available.
3. **Anything weirder than that** — text Hamid. He can screen-share within a few hours.

You don't need to do all of this in one go — pause whenever, the flows you've saved as **Live** will start working straight away, and the unfinished ones just won't fire yet.

Good luck — and thank you for taking this on!